

TAB 9



Board of Education Report

[Back to Order of Business](#)

File #: Res-013-22/23, Version: 2

Dr. Rivas, Ms. Ortiz Franklin - Celebrating Women's History and Addressing Present Day Disparities and Gaps for Women and Girls in LAUSD (Res-013-22/23) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, Women's History Month is dedicated to honoring and acknowledging women's immeasurable contributions to our past and present in the face of discrimination and undue hardship, and is celebrated in March throughout the United States and abroad, corresponding with March 8th, International Women's Day. While we celebrate many female leaders, and the progress made towards gender equality, we acknowledge that women still face many societal barriers. For example, women still only earn 82 cents for every dollar earned by men, and the wage gap is even larger for women of color, with Black women earning 64 cents, and Hispanic women earning 57 cents despite having high rates of workforce participation;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District is a committed leader in education, embracing all forms of diversity, including supporting the educational achievement of the young women, girls, and youth affected by gender-based discrimination who attend our schools, as expressed by Priorities 1C, 2A, 2B, and 2C, and 5C of the 2022-2026 LAUSD Strategic Plan;

Whereas, The term young women and girls includes cis and trans women, non-binary and gender nonconforming individuals, impacted by gender-based discrimination;

Whereas, According to the Youth Risk Behavior Survey recently released by the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC), teen girls and LGBTQ youth fared worse on most measures of health behaviors and experiences:

- 30 percent of girls said they seriously considered attempting suicide, double the rate among boys and up almost 60 percent from a decade ago,
- Almost 20 percent of girls reported experiencing rape or other sexual violence in the previous year, also an increase over previous years,
- Almost half of LGBTQ students said they had seriously considered a suicide attempt.

Whereas, According to the same CDC report, the pandemic took a harsh toll on U.S. teen girls' mental health, with almost 60 percent reporting feelings of persistent sadness or hopelessness;

Whereas, Research indicates that social media activity is linked to lower self-esteem and body dysmorphia among teenage girls; and

Whereas, Schools play a critical role not just in academic learning, but in creating environments that protect against risk factors and play a critical role in shaping mental, physical, and social growth for young women and girls; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District celebrates the month of

March as Women's History Month, and celebrates March 8th, International Women's Day as a way to honor the movement for women's rights movement, bringing attention to issues such as gender equality, reproductive rights, and violence and abuse against women;

Resolved further, That to address disparities and create schools where young women and girls can thrive, the District restates its commitment to the following priorities of the 2022-2026 Strategic Plan:

1. Pillar 1, Priority C: Eliminating Opportunity Gaps
2. Pillar 2, Priorities A, B, and C: Safe and Healthy Environments to Promote Joy and Wellness
3. Pillar 5, Priority C: Cultivating Staff Wellness; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Superintendent will report to the Board in 60 days about positive and pro-active interventions that the District has implemented to support the mental health of our youth and District staff, disaggregating the use of interventions by gender, race, and other relevant equity analysis, including highlighting specific school sites or programs that:

1. Offer school-based services connecting youth and adults to community-based sources of care, preventative counseling and therapeutic intervention;
2. Establish inclusive, safe and positive environments on our campuses;
3. Ensure equitable outcomes for youth and adults affected by gender-based discrimination; and
4. Provide tools and resources to engage in positive self-esteem and body image, including healthy practices regarding social media usage.